

Duke Energy's Aquatic Plant Management Program

Eryn Molloy
NC DEQ Lake Tillery Meeting
March 13, 2024



BUILDING A SMARTER ENERGY FUTURE®

Our Role



North Carolina Department of Environmental Quality

Divisions AccessDEQ Outreach & Education Energy & Climate News About

About Divisions Water Resources Water Planning Water Supply Planning Aquatic Weed Control Program

Aquatic Weed Control Program

Purpose

The purpose of the Aquatic Weed Control Program is to provide units of local government and residents of North Carolina with resources that will promote the prevention and management of noxious aquatic weed infestations. The philosophy is that by offering assistance and developing partnerships, aquatic weeds will be more efficiently managed across the state.

The program's two primary objectives are:

1. Respond to localized infestations to mitigate the long-term economic and environmental impacts that noxious aquatic weeds impose.
2. Reduce the frequency of aquatic weed introductions through education and public awareness.

The philosophy of the program applies to aquatic weed infestations of all sizes. Large-scale projects can be complex and challenging. They may span jurisdictions and require the development of partnerships. Aquatic weed control projects may involve federal, state and local governments as well as non-government organizations and private landowners. The program often serves as a major contributor of funding and provides leadership on large-scale projects. Benefits are realized by offering assistance for small-scale projects as well. Allowing aquatic weeds to persist and spread throughout our waterways only exacerbates the problem.

The NC Aquatic Nuisance Species Management Plan provides a detailed explanation of why aquatic

Water Supply Planning
Water Supply Development Assistance
Water Use Reporting
Interbasin Transfer Certification
Water Conservation
Aquatic Weed Control Program
Alligatorweed (<i>Alternanthera philoxeroides</i>)
Eurasian Watermillet (<i>Monobrydium seicatum</i>)
Hydrilla (<i>Hydrilla verticillata</i>)
Giant Salvinia (<i>Salvinia modesta</i>)
Common Reed (<i>Phragmites australis</i>)
Creeping Water Primrose (<i>Ludwigia grandiflora</i>)

SCDNR Aquatic Nuisance Species Program

Buy Boating Education Fishing Hunting Land Regulations Water Wildlife

ANS Home

- Program Overview
- Managed Areas
- Publications
- Aquatic Plant Management Plan**
- Homeowner Info
- Illegal Species
- Zebra Mussels
- Island Applesnails
- Alien Invaders 101
- Habitat
- Aquatic Plant Mgmt. Council
- Aquatic Invasive Species Task Force
- Aquatic Invasive Species Plan
- Related Links

Some of the Specific State Laws which pertain to Illegal, Noxious, or Nuisance Species:

Title 46, Chapter 23 - South Carolina Noxious Weed Act

Provides far reaching powers to seize, quarantine, treat, destroy, apply other remedial measures, to export, return to shipping point, or otherwise dispose of in such a manner as (it) deems appropriate, any noxious weed or any product or article of any character whatsoever or any means of conveyance which (it) has reason to believe contains or is contaminated with any noxious weed, offered for movement, moving, or has moved into or through the state or intrastate. To further deter persons from spreading nuisance aquatic weeds the law includes fines not exceeding \$500 and/or imprisonment not exceeding one year.

Title 46, Chapter 9 - State Crop Pest Act

The State Crop Pest Commission is authorized by law (Section 46-9-40) to promulgate and enforce reasonable regulations to eradicate or prevent the introduction, spread or dissemination of plant pests. Plant pests are by definition (Section 46-9-15(5)) any living state of insects, mites, nematodes, slugs, animals, protozoa, snails or other invertebrate animals, bacteria, weeds, fungi, other parasitic plants...which directly or indirectly may injure or cause disease or damage in plants...and which may be a serious agricultural threat to the State, as determined by the Director.

The State Crop Pest Commission is responsible for control of plant pests which constitute a threat to production agriculture. In so doing, the Commission is the primary contact point for cooperation with the Animal and Plant Health Inspection Service (APHIS), U. S. Department of Agriculture.

The Commission has designated certain organisms as plant pests. These organisms are already designated as noxious weeds by state and/or federal authorities or are under domestic federal quarantine. Once a plant pest has been designated, the Commission has the authority to impose control measures, up to and including, quarantine of the premises. However, the Director, as the



New Reporting Tool

duke-energy.com/AquaticPlants

Aquatic Plant Management

A key aspect of being a good environmental steward is monitoring and managing our rivers and lakes for aquatic plants and wildlife. Invasive species threaten the well-being of these systems by impeding recreation, impacting navigation, and/or clogging water intake and control structures.

Aquatic Plants in our Reservoirs

Many invasive aquatic plants have the potential to invade Duke Energy's lakes and rivers. Typically, these plants were introduced to the United States for use in aquariums and water gardens, and have since spread across the country and into our lakes over time. With no natural controls in the environment, they rapidly spread and can quickly begin to impact our aquatic ecosystems. Invasive aquatic plants can quickly take over, leaving little room for swimming, fishing and boating, which poses severe risk to intakes used for drinking water and power production.

Duke Energy's Aquatic Plant Management Program extensively surveys these lakes during the summer months when the plants typically emerge. When deemed

Related Links

-  [Aquatic Plant Reporting Form](#)
-  [Catawba-Wateree Aquatic Plant Survey](#)
-  [Hydrilla Fact Sheet](#)
-  [What to Know About Harmful Algal Blooms](#)
-  [How Duke Energy's aquatic plant scientists survey lake shorelines](#)



Aquatic Plant Report - Duke Energy

Please fill out the following to report any issues regarding aquatic plants to Duke Energy's Aquatic Plant Management Program.

To learn more about how Duke Energy manages aquatic plants, visit our website duke-energy.com/AquaticPlants.

Name*

Eryn Molloy

Email*

This is only to be used if there is additional follow up needed

AquaticPlants@duke-energy.com

Phone number

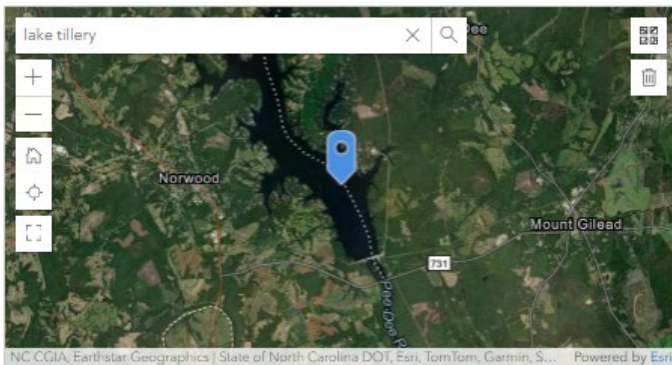
ex: 704-222-1919

Lake name

Tillery

Plant location*

Please try to report as close as possible to location where the plant was seen



Key takeaways:

- Provides contact information
- Plant location
- Photo of plant for ID
- Amount of area impacted
- Reporting tool is found on our website: duke-energy.com/AquaticPlants

This information is communicated to the appropriate state resource agencies for incorporation into management plan



How to Take a Good ID Photo



How to Get in Touch

For aquatic plant questions

AquaticPlants@duke-energy.com

For permitting questions

LakeServices@duke-energy.com



Stop the spread of invasive aquatic species

Take these 4 steps after each trip on the water

CLEAN: equipment of aquatic plants and animals

DRAIN: water from boats, live wells, and equipment

DRY: allow equipment to thoroughly dry

NEVER MOVE: fish, plants or other organisms from one body of water to another

Warm water hitchhikers to be on the lookout for:



Hydrilla



Zebra Mussel



Giant Salvinia



Crested Floating Heart

For more information about aquatic hitchhikers visit:

www.protectyourwaters.net

